MCP

Title:
Not For Sale

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Not For Sale
By Blair Waite

Woman sitting alone in park on a bench.

Man walks in carrying a bucket of roses… sees woman and smiles. He watches her for a few seconds without her noticing, then Man approaches woman with the roses.

Man: Beautiful rose for a beautiful lady?

Woman: No thank you.

Man: No, really, have a rose.

Hands her a rose, she does not take it.

Woman: No, thank you.

Man: Here is a rose.

Hands her a rose, she does not take it.

Woman: I don't want to buy one.

Man: They are not for sale.

Woman: How is that? You have a bucket of them. There are easily over 100 roses in there. It sure looks like you are trying to sell them.

Man: Well I am not.

Woman: But it LOOKS like you are.

Man: I just want to give you a rose, they are not for sale, all right. It's a gift.

Woman: That's awfully nice of you, but I still don't want a rose.

Man: You really should take one. A beautiful rose for a beautiful lady.

Woman: Do you get your jollies from wandering around the park handing out roses or something? Take a hint.

Man: Just take a rose.

Woman: What am I supposed to do with it?

Man: Smell it, love its beauty.

Woman: I'm just waiting on someone, I don't have anywhere to put it. It would just be wasted on me.

Man: It would not be wasted on such a beauty.

Woman: Thank you, but still no.

Man: Who are you waiting for?

Woman: A man.

Man: Well, *(looks around for a moments)* looks like he is not here.

Woman: Obviously. *(Looks at watch)* He was supposed to be here 5 minutes ago.

Man: Looks like he might not show up. Why don't you take a rose to cheer you up?

Woman: I still don't want a rose.

Man starts to walk away but turns back

Man: Do you know this person?

Woman: We've only talked online and on the phone, this is our first meeting. I may be getting stood up.

Man: Uh oh. Who would stand up such a beautiful lady?

Man takes a seat next to the woman.

Woman: His name is Chris. I don't even know what he looks like, but we've been talking for months now. I feel like I know him, may even be falling in love with him. I don't know why I am telling you this, you are a stranger who is selling roses in the park.

Man: They are not for sale.

Woman: Doesn't matter. You are a stranger.

Man: I may be a stranger, but I'm willing to listen. I have all day. *(pauses then says jokingly)* Sales are slow.

Woman: See, I was right, you ARE selling them!

Man: It sounds like you really like this Chris guy. What is it about him?

Woman: We talk on the phone and online for hours at a time. I tell him my deepest secrets and I think he tells me his. He's becoming my best friend. He just has a way of putting me to ease and making my day brighter by just talking to me. I can tell him the mundane details of my life and he seems to think it is the most interesting thing in the world. He is the best part of my day, the first person I want to talk to when anything happens. I talk to him first thing when I wake up and always right before going to bed. We met on a dating site, I almost blew him off because he didn't have a profile picture. He said the reason he didn't was he believes that the beauty inside a person is what is important and having a picture does not allow a person to get to know someone on a deeper level.

Man: I get that. If you get to know someone for who they are instead of what they look like it really is better. Like they say, looks fade.

Woman: The fact that he has not shown up is starting to make me wonder if he is even real.

Man: Why wouldn't he be real?

Woman: Well, he's not here. Maybe it was just some elaborate hoax to get some lonely girl to look like a fool.

Man: That's not very nice. I also don't think that is the case. Maybe something held him up?

Woman: I keep trying to tell myself that, which is why I am still sitting here waiting.

Man: I'm sure that is the it. Maybe he was nervous and needed a few minutes before he could see you in person. Or maybe he saw you and was so stunned by your beauty he couldn't approach you.

Woman: That's just silly, but I guess he could be a little nervous. He has always seemed so confident in the past though when we have talked. I was sure he would show up and he sounded so sincere in wanting to meet me.

Man: There must be some reason you have not met up in person yet though, right?

Woman: I've never thought about that…

Man: Just something maybe you should have thought about.

Woman: What? Are you saying he is some three-legged freak or a serial killer or something?

Man: *(laughs)* No, just that maybe he is not perfect and afraid to show himself to you for fear that that would reject him. Men have fragile egos sometimes.

Woman: Oh my, what if he is a serial killer? What if he shows up and then takes me into the woods and murders me? What if he locks me in his basement? What if he thinks this is just some sick game to mess with my head? Lure me in and then treat me cruelly? What if he makes me put lotion on my skin like in that movie! I've heard that serial killers are really charming.

He's really charming. He's also very smart, serial killers are supposed to be really smart too. He's sweet and funny and he will probably murder me!

Man: Whoa whoa whoa, calm down. I think you are getting too worked up right now. Why don't you have a rose. It will help you calm down.

Hands her a rose which she pushes away

Woman: I don't want a rose. Not from you anyway.

Man: Why wouldn't you want a rose from me? I can be sweet and charming! I promise I'm not a serial killer.

Woman: Stop it. You are fine, I just don't want a rose. You know what I meant. I want a rose from HIM, not you.

Man: Have you ever seen a picture of this Chris guy? Do you even know who you are waiting for?

Woman: *(Defensive)* No.

Man: You mean to tell me you are waiting around for a person, but you don't know who to look for? He could be anyone. What about that guy over there walking his dog? Or that jogger over there? Or the guy feeding the ducks? What about that older man sitting on the bench by the lake? It could be any of them if you didn't see a picture.

Woman: He's told me what he looks like. He's medium height, brown eyes, brown hair *(describe whoever the rose man is)*

Man: Sounds like a lot of people, nothing really all that descriptive.

Woman: Thanks for pointing that out, I didn't already know that.

Man: I didn't mean anything by that. Have a rose.

Woman: Not now, no roses. I'm too upset.

Man: Roses have a way of cheering people up.

Woman: I don't think anything can cheer me up right now except Chris… and maybe he doesn't even exist. Maybe he's really a woman! I've heard of stories like that.

Man: A woman? *(laughs)* You said you've talked to him on the phone, right?

Woman: Yes.

Man: Wouldn't you have been able to tell? Wouldn't he have a higher voice or something?

Woman: I suppose you are right on that one. So… Chris is not a woman… but he could still be a serial killer.

Man: I think that is highly unlikely as well. I'm sure he just got caught up with something and will be here soon. Would you like me to wait with you? You can have a rose while we wait and if Chris shows up and you don't want it anymore, just give it back.

Woman: I don't want Chris to see me sitting with another guy and then get the wrong idea.

Man: How 'bout I just stand over here? Still close enough that we can talk, but not too close… He will probably just think I'm selling roses like you do and not think anything of it.

Woman: I suppose that would be okay. It is nice to have a little company while I wait, but don't be too close.

Man: Ok.

A few seconds of awkward silence.

Man: Hey, do you think that is him walking towards us?

Perks up, then let down, it's not him.

Woman: No, he's got a little kid with him.

Man: Chris could have a kid?

Woman: He told me he doesn't have any children, but he wants them someday. He's told me all about what he wants in life.

Man: Oh?

Woman: Yeah, he wants a big family, 5 kids, ha! He wants to travel and see the world before having them, but he's always wanted a big family. I come from a small family, so it would be nice to have lots of people around. Chris says he comes from a big family and loves the sound of laughter filling a house. I can just imagine it. He wants to move his way up in his job to sales manager and buy a house in the suburbs. He wants to be a real family man, build a tree house for the kids, things like that. This house he wants would have a white picket fence and a rose garden! The perfect life!

Man: A rose garden you say?

Woman: He says he really loves roses…

Man: *(pause)* Why don't you have a rose, Rachel?

Woman: *(distracted, dreaming of the future with Chris)* I told you, I don't want a rose right now. Wait. How do you? What?

Man: Hi, I’m Chris.

Woman: What?! I’m… what?

Man: I thought I would surprise you with 150 red roses, one for each day I have known… and loved you.

They embrace.